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b. Thyroid stimulating hormone (TSH)

TSH controls the growth of thyroid gland, coordinates its activities and hormone secretion.

c. Adrenocorticotropic hormone (ACTH)

ACTH stimulates adrenal cortex of the adrenal gland for the production of its hormones. It also influences protein synthesis in the adrenal cortex.

d. Gonadotropic hormones (GTH)

The gonadotropic hormones are follicle stimulating hormone and luteinizing hormone which are essential for the normal development of gonads.

Follicle stimulating hormone (FSH)

In male, it stimulates the germinal epithelium of testes for formation of sperms. In female it initiates the growth of ovarian follicles and its development in ovary.

Luteinizing hormone (LH)

In male, it promotes the Leydig cells of the testes to secrete male sex hormone testosterone. In female, it causes ovulation (rupture of mature graafian follicle), responsible for the development of corpus luteum and production of female sex hormones estrogen and progesterone.

e. Prolactin (PRL)

PRL is also called **lactogenic hormone**. This hormone initiates development of mammary glands during pregnancy and stimulates the production of milk after child birth.

Hormones secreted by the posterior lobe (Neurohypophysis) of pituitary

The hormones secreted by the posterior pituitary are

a. Vasopressin or Antidiuretic hormone

b. Oxytocin

a. Vasopressin or Antidiuretic hormone (ADH)

In kidney tubules it increases reabsorption of water. It reduces loss of water through urine and hence the name antidiuretic hormone.

Deficiency of ADH reduces reabsorption of water and causes an increase in urine output (polyuria). This deficiency disorder is called **Diabetes insipidus**.

b. Oxytocin

It helps in the contraction of the smooth muscles of uterus at the time of child birth and milk ejection from the mammary gland after child birth.

More to Know

Melatonin is a hormone produced by the pineal gland. It is known as a 'time messenger'. It signals night time information throughout the body.

Exposure to light at night, especially short-wavelength light, can decrease melatonin production interrupting sleep. Suppression of melatonin has been implicated in sleep disturbances and related metabolic disorders.

16.2.2 Thyroid Gland

The thyroid gland is composed of two distinct lobes lying one on either side of the trachea. The two lobes are connected by means of a narrow band of tissue known as the **isthmus**. This gland is composed of glandular follicles and

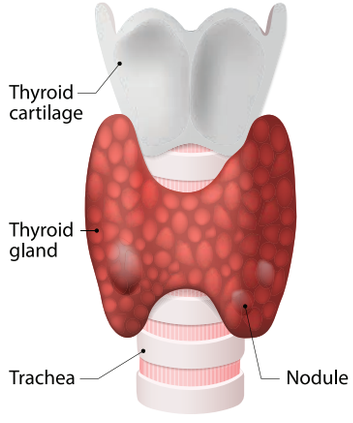


Figure 16.8 Thyroid Gland

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